of all the constituents should not be less than 20,000 (as per 1991 census).

Urban agglomeration is a continuous urban spread constituting a town and its adjoining urban outgrowths (OGs), or two or more physical contiguous towns together and any adjoining urban outgrowths of such towns. Examples of Outgrowth are railway colonies, university campuses, port area, military camps etc. that may have come up near a statutory town or city but within the revenue limits of a village or villages contiguous to the town or city. With these two basic criteria having been met, the following are the possible different situations in which urban agglomerations could be constituted.

i) A city or town with one or more contiguous outgrowths.

ii) Two or more adjoining towns with or without their outgrowths.

iii) A city and one or more adjoining towns with their outgrowths all of which form a continuous spread.

Standard urban area

A new concept that had been developed for the 1971 Census for the tabulation of certain urban data was the Standard Urban Area.

The essential of a Standard Urban Area are:

(i) It should have a core town of a minimum population size of 50,000.

(ii) The contiguous areas made up of other urban as well as rural administrative units should have close mutual socio-economic links with the core town and

(iii) The probabilities are that this entire area will get fully urbanized in a period of two to three decades.

The idea is that it should be possible to provide comparable data for a definite area of urbanization continuously for three decades which would give a meaningful picture. This replaced the concepts of Town Group that was in vogue at the 1961 Census. The town groups were made up of independent urban units not necessarily contiguous to one another but were to some extent inter-dependent. The data for such town groups became incomparable from census to census as the boundaries of the towns themselves changed and the intermediate areas were left out of account; this concept came for criticism at one of the symposium of the International Geographic Union in 1968 and the concept of Standard Urban Area came to be developed for adoption at the 1971 Census. If data for this Standard Area were to be made available in the next two or three successive censuses, it is likely to yield much more meaningful picture to study urbanisation around large urban nuclei.



Ecumenopolis (Ecumeno means world; polis means city) is a single city encompassing the whole world that is held to be a possibility of the future.

Basis for classification of urban settlements

The definition of urban areas varies from one country to another. Some of the common bases of classification are size of population, occupational structure and Administrative setup.

Population size

In India the size of population, density of 400 persons per sq km and share of non-agricultural workers are taken into consideration.

Occupational structure

In India if more than 50 per cent of its economically productive population is engaged in non-agricultural pursuits.

Administration Setup

For example, in India, a settlement of any size is classified as urban, if it has a municipality, Cantonment Board or Notified Area Council.

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